



1 Mark Zuckerberg, CEO of Meta, is famous for his iconic sweatshirt and jeans attire in office

2 Except for formal occasions, Barack Obama preferred a tie-less-rolled-up-sleeves look for the White House

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evident from the fact that it was carried as news by leading international publications, as it was once considered unimaginable for the Wall Street firm. It was done to bring the bank's traditional policies up to date for its younger workforce—nearly 75% of Goldman employees are Gen Z, or Millennials.

Today, it is comfort that wins over stiff corporate attire, and that's true not only for the younger generation but also for those who have been working in the corporate sector for a long time. "I wear ties nowadays for events as statement clothing. The work environment today is more about performance and less about formality. It's the mental ease," says Sharad Gautam, a senior executive with a leading global alco-bev company. Agrees Aman Vohra, a management consultant-turned digital content creator: "In today's dynamic work culture, where flexibility and personal expression are increasingly valued,

the once rigid dress codes have been relaxed, allowing individuals to explore a wider range of styles."

Of course, the tie will always be a part of a man's wardrobe. But has it been reduced to a special events-only garment? A relic of tradition and redolent with historical meaning but not relevancy? Even Ermenegildo Zegna, Chief Executive of Zegna, has given up on ties. "Let me be clear: the suit is not dead," Zegna said at a luxury conference in May 2022. "But the tie is!"

"Although ties still hold significance in certain professional settings and events, I feel that more or less, their usage seems to be very limited. They will definitely remain a symbol of elegance and sophistication in menswear, but customers have started leaning towards ties as formal or else occasion wear, though to me it signifies old world elegance and unmatched style," says designer Varun Bahl. In India, the rise of Indian wear at for-

mal occasions is also impacting the wearing of ties. "Over the years, I have realised that a smart *bandhgala* is far more comfortable and chic," says 47-year-old PR professional Sayantan Sinha. Agrees digital content creator, Riaan George: "We are not wearing ties even on formal occasions as in India a lot of us have adopted the *bandi* (Nehru) jacket instead of the blazer. Even Air India and Vistara have ditched the ties for their male attendants, replacing them with *bandi* jackets."

While looking around us, we may feel that the tie is losing its significance in men's fashion, it hasn't impacted sales. As per research firm Verified Market Reports, the size of the global ties market is expected to grow at a CAGR of 6.9% to \$261.78 million by 2030 from \$153.5 million in 2023.

At the end of the day, you choose to tie or not to tie! **BT**

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